

Treasury’s Hurley to exit post amid clash

He raised objections over targeting of alleged fraud in the Somali community

BY ANDREW ACKERMAN,
JEFF STEIN,
NATALIE ALLISON
AND ELLEN NAKASHIMA

A top Trump Treasury official is leaving his post after privately raising objections to White House-backed plans to crack down on alleged fraud within the Somali immigrant community in Minnesota, according to seven people familiar with the matter.

John Hurley, a donor to President Donald Trump who is serving as the undersecretary for terrorism and financial intelligence, began telling associates in recent weeks that he was leaving his post. Hurley had recently conveyed his concerns to Treasury Secretary Scott Bessent about a project to enhance federal monitoring of international payments from the Minneapolis area, according to the people, who spoke on the condition of anonymity to discuss internal deliberations.

His departure underscores how some Trump allies in the federal government are uneasy with the extent of White House directives to deploy law enforcement tools against Minneapolis’s Somali community. Two of the people said he raised data privacy concerns over the plans in question.

Hurley’s internal objections to the Somali fraud plan haven’t previously been reported. His departure is the latest senior-level exit at the Treasury Department, which has seen the departure of two chiefs of staff under Bessent, as well as the resignation of his top deputy in August.

Hurley denied the premise of this article, but Treasury officials declined to make him available for an on-the-record interview.

In a statement, Hurley praised the work of his team as “the tip of the spear pushing back to stop Somalia fraud in Minnesota.”

“Anyone who has told you I do not proudly support these America first efforts is either uninformed or malicious,” he said.

Trump has directed Cabinet officials to prioritize the issue of cracking down on fraud after it was reignited by viral videos and federal charges this fall against

SEE SANCTIONS ON A4



CAROLYN VAN HOUTEN/THE WASHINGTON POST

Marina Kyziminska, 16, works with an assault rifle last year during a Protecting Ukraine course in Bucha.

From her wooden schoolroom seat, Katya, 15, carefully eyes the assault rifles laid across the desks up front.

Her mind flashes to the Russian checkpoint four years ago.

She is crammed in the back of a neighbor’s car clutching her aunt’s cat as fear rises to her throat. Russian soldiers are pressed up against the car window, seething with anger, fingers on the triggers of their black guns.

The teacher’s voice snaps her back to the present.

“God willing, none of you will ever need the knowledge you gain here, not even once. But if, God forbid, it happens that you do

As war with Russia drags on, the children of Ukraine learn to fight back

With threats expected to last for years, teenagers enroll in defense course

BY SIOBHÁN O’GRADY, ANASTACIA GALOUCHKA
AND SERHIY MORGUNOV
IN BUCHA, UKRAINE

need it — that you cross paths with these situations — it’s better that you know what needs to be done at any given moment,” he says. “Understood?”

Katya nods. She looks again at the training guns. She isn’t scared anymore. Scared is for 11-year-old Katya in the back seat of that car. Scared is for the little girl trembling in the basement, whose mother covered her with her body while Russian war planes circled overhead.

If Russian troops ever return to Bucha, Katya doesn’t want to be scared. She intends to be ready.

The teacher asks for volunteers to try loading a rifle. Katya’s hand shoots up.

SEE UKRAINE ON A8

U.S.-Iran nuclear talks ratchet up as clock ticks down to war

BY KAREN DEYOUNG
AND NOAH ROBERTSON

On the eve of a third round of nuclear talks between the United States and Iran on Thursday in Geneva, where Tehran is expected to deliver a new proposal, much of the world is holding its breath to see if the massive military force President Donald Trump has assembled in the Middle East is a threat designed to bring the Iranians to heel or a promise to attack if negotiations don’t immediately

Tehran expected to offer proposal under threat of Trump’s military armada

produce a deal to his liking.

“I don’t think a final decision has been made yet,” said Sen. Mark R. Warner (D-Virginia), one of a small group of senior congressional leaders briefed on the president’s plans just hours before

Trump delivered the annual State of the Union speech Tuesday evening in front of a joint session of lawmakers.

“Now whether you believe that or not is a totally different question,” said one person familiar with the administration’s outreach to lawmakers who spoke on the condition of anonymity regarding sensitive discussions.

Trump’s address provided few if any clues as to his ultimate intentions. He repeated claims to have “obliterated Iran’s nuclear

weapons program” with airstrikes in June but said the Iranians were starting to rebuild it and “are at this moment pursuing their sinister ambitions.” He said Iran has refused to pledge never to have a nuclear weapon and was already working on intercontinental ballistic missiles (ICBMs) “that will soon reach” the continental United States.

All of those assertions have been questioned by international nuclear inspectors, who have

SEE IRAN ON A7

Surgeon general nominee grilled on vaccines, pesticides

Means draws criticism and praise from both sides of the aisle

BY LAUREN WEBER
AND RACHEL ROUBEIN

The Senate Health Committee grilled Casey Means on whether she supports certain vaccines, her past business entanglements and her previous criticism of pesticides, as they weigh whether she should serve as the nation’s top doctor.

President Donald Trump’s surgeon general nominee drew fire and praise from both sides of the aisle on Wednesday, reflecting the crosscutting appeal of the Make America Healthy Again

coalition. Means, a health products entrepreneur and popular online personality, wrote the book considered the MAHA bible with her brother, Calley Means, a Trump administration official.

Staying largely unruffled, Means found common ground with many senators with her push to steer Americans’ diets away from ultra-processed foods. But she dodged most questions about her specific views on vaccinations and did not explicitly recommend all Americans receive the measles and flu shots, instead saying they should talk with their doctors.

The hearing at times served as a referendum on the agenda of her political patron, Health Secretary Robert F. Kennedy Jr., who has overhauled federal vaccine guidelines and upended the public

SEE MEANS ON A4



ANDREW HARNIK/GETTY IMAGES

U.S. surgeon general nominee Casey Means, right, a health entrepreneur and online personality, holds hands with her partner, Brian Nickerson, on Wednesday at her Senate committee hearing.

Cuba: 4 killed on U.S. vessel

HAVANA SAYS CREW INTENDED TERROR

10 aboard were Cuban nationals, ministry says

BY SAMANTHA SCHMIDT,
ADAM TAYLOR,
KAREN DEYOUNG
AND CHRISTINE ARMARIO

The American speedboat that Cuban officials said opened fire on border agents Wednesday was carrying 10 armed Cubans who were attempting to infiltrate the country “for terrorist purposes,” the country’s Interior Ministry said.

Cuban authorities seized assault rifles, handguns, molotov cocktails, body armor and fatigues from the Florida-registered vessel, the ministry said in a statement late Wednesday. The men on board were Cuban nationals who had been living in the United States, the ministry said.

The speedboat was less than a nautical mile off Villa Clara province on Cuba’s northern coast Wednesday morning when Cuban border agents approached and asked for identification, the ministry said earlier. The men on the speedboat opened fire on the Cuban vessel, the ministry said, wounding its commander.

The Cuban forces returned fire, the ministry said, killing four men aboard the speedboat and wounding six. The wounded were evacuated to receive medical attention.

Cuban authorities named the six survivors and one of the four who were killed. They were working to identify the other three deceased.

SEE CUBA ON A12

Trump solicits and considers bids to revamp Dulles Airport

BY DAN DIAMOND

President Donald Trump is personally driving efforts to remake Dulles International Airport — and his plans go far beyond trying to put his name on it.

Trump earlier this month hosted about a half-dozen infrastructure and construction companies in the Oval Office, with executives taking turns pitching the president and Transportation Secretary Sean P. Duffy on their proposals to overhaul the Washington-area airport, according to four people familiar with the plans who spoke on the condition of anonymity to discuss the private meeting. The companies — which included AECOM, one of the firms working on the president’s White House ballroom project — laid out ideas to change Dulles’s layout, build new terminals and do away with the airport’s sometimes notorious shuttles known as people movers, the people said.

Trump convened companies again Wednesday to hear updated proposals for redesigning one of the country’s most prominent

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More Epstein fallout Lawrence Summers quit teaching at Harvard following a review of his relationship with the sex offender. A5

THE NATION A federal judge ruled that the White House’s third-country removal policy is unlawful. A2
Marco Rubio visited the Caribbean as the prospect of conflict in the Mideast looms. A12

THE WORLD A court in Brazil convicted an ex-lawmaker in the death of politician Marielle Franco. A11
Iranians are looking at the U.S. raid to capture Maduro for hints of Trump’s next move. A11

THE ECONOMY In his speech, the president floated a new retirement benefit and a \$1,000 government match, but critics say he lacks legal authority. A16
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STYLE As the president spoke to the nation, these anti-Trumpers threw a resistance party. B1

SPORTS Trea Turner, the former National playing up the road in Philadelphia, has long made speed a calling card. At 32, he still has it. B7

THE REGION A staffer at a Maryland assisted-living facility has been charged with killing an 87-year-old resident. B11

LOCAL LIVING The case for keeping your garden dark: Outdoor lighting is having an outsized impact on the flora and fauna.

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